

Maxime Cugnon de Sévricourt

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Georgetown University, Washington, D.C. 2020 – 2026

Job Market Paper: *“Electoral Gambles: Why Politicians Choose Risky Policies”*

Committee: Laurent Bouton (chair), Axel Anderson, Juan Felipe Riaño

Master’s in Economics, Sciences Po, Paris, France 2016 – 2018

Master’s in Human Resources, Sciences Po, Paris, France 2014 – 2016

B.A. in Social Sciences (Cum Laude), Sciences Po, Paris, France 2011 – 2014

RESEARCH FIELDS

Microeconomics, Political Economy

WORKING PAPERS

Electoral Gambles: Why Politicians Choose Risky Policies [*Job Market Paper*]

We extend a standard two-period electoral accountability model with two types of politicians by allowing incumbents to choose both the mean and the variance of policy outcomes. Without electoral incentives, both types prefer the lowest variance. We show that when the value of holding office is high enough, however, the low type may strategically increase variance to raise the chance of re-election, at the expense of voter welfare. This goes against the usual responsiveness result that higher office benefit provides incentives for low-type incumbents to behave in the best interest of the voters.

WORK IN PROGRESS

In Search of Lost Correlation: Correlated Equilibrium via Marginal Actions (with Christopher P. Chambers and Christopher Turansick) [*arXiv*]

In this paper, we study which data can be induced by a correlated equilibrium given a known finite simultaneous move game. We assume that an analyst has access to the frequency of each agent’s actions but does not have access to the distribution over joint action profiles. We characterize which sets of marginal distributions over actions arise from some correlated equilibria via a type of no arbitrage condition. An outside observer is unable to make a profit in expectation by independently contracting with each agent and collecting a portion of the total utility gained via unilateral deviation. This characterization naturally extends to Nash equilibria.

An Axiomatic Representation of Diagnostic Expectations (with Danell Benguigui)

We characterize the belief-updating rule used in the macroeconomic literature on diagnostic expectations. We show that this rule can be derived from three key properties: probabilities of complementary events sum up to one, posterior odds are homogeneous of degree one in prior odds, and they depend only on simple sufficient statistics of the prior, plus some regularity conditions. This fills an important gap in the literature by providing a precise theoretical foundation for diagnostic expectations and a better understanding of its implications.

Why People Vote: Comparing Models of Voter Turnout (with Luke B. Miller)

This paper provides a systematic comparison of leading theoretical models of voter turnout using a common empirical framework. We structurally estimate calculus of voting, mobilization, persuasion, and group-norm models on U.S. House and state special election data. Formal model selection tests show that a calculus of voting model best fits observed turnout in federal elections, while mobilization models perform better in low-salience special elections.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Prof. Laurent Bouton, Georgetown University 2021 – Present
Conducted empirical analysis on large-scale datasets of political contributions.

Research Assistant to Prof. Arik Levinson, Georgetown University 2021 – Present
Conducted empirical analysis for a project on environmental justice.

Pre-Doctoral Research Fellow, University of Oxford 2019 – 2020
Global Priorities Institute — conducted empirical analysis on economic complexity and long-run growth; co-authored the Institute's research agenda.

Research Assistant to Prof. Francis Kramarz, CREST 2018 – 2019
Helped develop and simulated a new search and matching model to estimate the effect of the 2003 severance payment reform in Austria

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lead Instructor, Georgetown University 2021 – Present
Math Camp for Incoming PhD Students in Economics
Designed syllabus and taught proof writing, fundamentals of logic and set theory, and real analysis

Teaching Assistant, Georgetown University 2021 – Present

Microeconomics I (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Axel Anderson	Fall 2025
Microeconomics II (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Roger Lagunoff	Spring 2025
Microeconomics II (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Axel Anderson	Fall 2024
Microeconomics II (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Luca Anderlini	Spring 2024
Microeconomics I (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Axel Anderson	Fall 2023
Microeconomics II (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Laurent Bouton	Spring 2023
Math for Economists (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Christopher P. Chambers	Fall 2022
Microeconomics II (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Laurent Bouton	Spring 2022
Microeconomics I (Ph.D.) – T.A. for Prof. Axel Anderson	Fall 2021

HONORS AND AWARDS

Sixth Year Funding Competition, Georgetown University	2025
Graduate Student Teaching Assistant Award, Georgetown University	2024
Global Priorities Fellowship, Forethought Foundation	2022
Graduate School Tuition Scholarship, Georgetown University	2020 – 2026
Graduate School Fellowship Stipend Award, Georgetown University	2020 – 2025

SERVICE

Referee, <i>Journal of Economic Theory</i>	2024
President, Georgetown Economics Graduate Student Organization	2023–2024

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, PyTorch, JAX, SQL, MATLAB, Stata, LaTeX
Machine Learning: Deep Learning, Reinforcement Learning
Data Analysis: Econometrics, Statistical Modeling, Causal Inference, Data Visualization

LANGUAGES

French (native), English (fluent, TOEFL iBT: 115)

REFERENCES

Laurent Bouton, Professor of Economics, Georgetown University
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Axel Anderson, Professor of Economics, Georgetown University
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Juan Felipe Riaño, Assistant Professor of Economics, Georgetown University
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